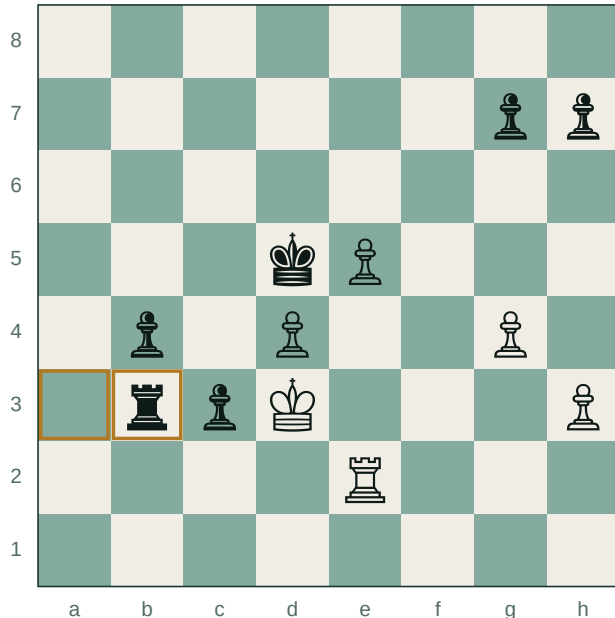


Rook-ending tactics: White, move 40

Rook-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 39...Rxb3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

40. e6 c2+ 41. Kxc2 Rc3+ 42. Kd2

40.e6 The pawn moves from e5 to e6. Recorded reply: **40...c2+**.

41.Kxc2 The king captures the pawn on c2. Recorded reply: **41...Rc3+**.

42.Kd2 The king moves from c2 to d2.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 8 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on d5. Geometrically undefended: rook on b3. Check for tactical protection.